

06 DAYS 05 NIGHTS BHUTAN OVERLAND TOUR

1N Phuentsholing | 1N Thimphu | 2N Paro | 1N Phuentsholing



OUTLINE ITINERARY (05 Nights 06 Days)

15 NOV Day 01: Arrive in Bagdogra and drive to Phuentsholing (Bhutan)

16 NOV Day 02: Phuentsholing to Thimphu

17 NOV Day 03: Thimphu to Paro

18 NOV Day 04: Paro

19 NOV Day 05: Paro Phuentsholing

20 NOV Day 06: Phuentsholing drop to Bagdogra airport

DETAILED ITINERARY

Day 01: Pickup from Bagdogra and drive to Phuentsholing. 155 kms 4 hrs

Once your flight reaches Bagdogra Airport in West Bengal, our eagerly waiting team will welcome you to the waiting vehicle. We now set off for the border town of Phuentsholing, our entry point to wonderful country of Bhutan.

During this 4-hour road journey, after passing slowly through the dense traffic of Siliguri city, we'll enter into open country and proceed on a comfortable, straight drive through and through till Phuentsholing.

As soon as we enter the Kingdom of Happiness in Phuentsholing, we can see the Bhutanese Himalayas from afar, beckoning us warmly for a delightful Bhutan experience. We arrive at our hotel in the Bhutanese town and spend the remaining day at leisure.

Day 02: Drive from Phuentsholing to Thimphu. 145 Km, 6 Hrs.

After completing these immigration formalities at Phuentsholing, we're all set to tour Bhutan.

Post breakfast, we leave the hotel and head for Thimphu, the Bhutanese capital. It's a 6-hour road trip with worthwhile halts at some of the must-visit tourist places in Bhutan.

- First in line is the incredible **Sangye Migyurling Lhakhang**, also known as **Milarepa Lhakhang**, is a place steeped in spirituality and rich cultural heritage. These 9 storied revered temples are dedicated to the legendary Buddhist figure, Milarepa
- Photo stop at the **Taktichu Pass** (2000 metres) at its huge, scenic waterfall. From this point, we can notice a transition in the forest scene - tropical vegetation giving way to coniferous trees.
- First stoppage after reaching Thimphu is the **Memorial Chorten**, dedicated to the founder of modern Bhutan. This tall, four-storeyed structure contains statues and symbols of several Tantric deities, undoubtedly ranking among the must-visit tourist places in Bhutan. Experience the fantastic sight of locals circumambulating the Chorten, holding prayer beads and murmuring the divine prayers.
- **Tashichho Dzong**, an impressive structure located just on the outskirts of Thimphu. One of Bhutan's most iconic monuments, the Tashichho Dzong houses His Majesty's throne room and several government offices. This massive fortress is also the summer residence of the central monastic body.

Head towards our hotel. Our team has selected one of the best hotels in Bhutan for your overnight stay in Thimphu.

Day 03: Thimphu – Paro. Overnight stay in Paro. 55 Km, 1 hrs.

We hope you had a good night's sleep in beautiful Bhutan! Enjoy the hotel's satiating breakfast before we begin our Thimphu tour today and proceed towards Paro.

- **Buddha Dordenma**, made in line with increasing the Bhutan happiness index. This sitting statue of Buddha measures 169 feet in height and is filled with 1,25,000 shorter Buddha statues. One of the world's most giant Buddha statues, Buddha Dordenma, with its peaceful and assuring appearance, draws innumerable tourists towards it. Also, this spot offers spectacular views of the Thimphu Valley.
- **Folk Heritage Museum** displays the impressive traditions and gives a glimpse of the country's history. A one-of-its kind "living" museum, visitors get to enjoy the Bhutanese songs, folk dances and finger-licious cuisine. One can actually live the country's culture by trying on traditional clothes and archery.

Now it's time to descend towards Paro town (1400m), our entry point by flight into amazing Bhutan. Paro lies in the thick, flourishing Paro Valley, in the backdrop of pristine mountain ranges. The hour-long drive to the breathtaking Paro Valley is a unique Bhutan travel experience, along crystal clear rivers and magnificent monuments.

- **Chuzom**, the meeting point of rivers Thimphu and Paro. You'll enjoy walking on the Chuzom bridge. Also, at this fascinating spot, you'll find three stunning chortens of Tibetan, Nepali, and Bhutanese styles. We're going to have a tough job interrupting your photography and reminding you to get inside the waiting vehicle!
- Photo stop at **Thamchok Lhakhang** which is just a short drive from Chuzom. It's a private temple under the ownership of a renowned iron chain bridge builder's scion. You can see the great man's creation even here - a fantastic chain bridge that leads to the temple.
- **National Museum (Ta Dzong)**. This hill-perched museum preserves the rich Bhutanese culture in the form of countless collections. Fine arts, bronze sculptures, jewellery, stuffed animals, stamps, and the list goes on. Another plus point of your museum visit is the spectacular view of Paro Valley from its viewpoint.
- **Paro (Rinpung) Dzong**. This 17th century, square-shaped citadel with a central tower and motified buildings is indeed an exemplary piece of Bhutan architecture. Paro Dzong is the administrative centre of the town. It houses courtyards, administrative offices, and a monastic area. Take the experience of crossing the traditional cantilever bridge with a shingle roof and a couple of watch houses on each end to our waiting vehicle. Finally, we return to the hotel for a delicious dinner and a peaceful sleep.

Day 04: Paro- Hike to Taktsang

Today, Post breakfast, we take a short drive on a blacktop road of green Bhutan to the end of Paro Valley.

- **Drukgyel Dzong**. This 17th Century dzong is a symbol of victory over the Tibetan aggression, Drukgyel Dzong served as an excellent barrier for several years against further attacks.
- **Taktsang Lhakhang**, more popularly called "**The Tiger's Nest**". This iconic monastery is so-called owing to the myth that the medieval Buddhist saint Padmasambhava visited it, riding a flying tiger. The legend also says that he meditated in a cave that is now the Nest's lower storey. The monastery houses a wrathful emanation of Padmasambhava on top of a tiger. You can reach this sacred place only through an uphill hike as it's perched on a precipitous rock face. It's a 5-hour trek through scenic pine forests, with the eluding view of the Nest beckoning you the whole time.

We return to the hotel. Enjoy the last dinner together before we all part ways tomorrow.

Day 05: Paro – Phuentsholing. Overnight stay in Phuentsholing. 145 Km, 5 Hrs

We take leave of beautiful Paro and retrace in the direction of Phuentsholing town. On our leisurely drive by the Paro River after crossing Chuzom and then towards Chukha, let's take in all the beautiful sights for one last time before descending towards our destination. After checking in to our hotel at the border town, we have the remaining time at leisure.

Day 06: Phuentsholing to Bagdogra airport drop. 155 Km, 3 Hrs

Post breakfast, we bid goodbye to the Kingdom of Happiness and set off on our journey home. After entering the Indian border at Jaigaon, we pass the scenic Bengal Countryside to arrive at Bagdogra Airport. We take the air journey with beautiful memories of our Bhutan travel. End of the Tour. *Goodbye to Bhutan with beautiful memories of Kingdom of Happiness*

HOTEL LIST PROPOSED. (NO FACILITIES ARE BOOKED AS OFF NOW)

	3 Star Standard	3 Star Deluxe	3 Star Premium
Phuentsholing	Alem Hotel Hotel Dewaling Hotel Palm Hotel Zhidey Hotel Bhutan Home	Alem Hotel Hotel Dewaling Hotel Palm Hotel Zhidey Hotel Bhutan Home	Hotel Lotus Villa Hotel Ga Me Ga
Thimphu	Hotel Migmar Forest Boutique Resort Hotel Khamsum Inn (Veg)	Hotel Changangkha Hotel PhuntshoPelri Hotel Bhutan Home Hotel Valley	Hotel Seven Suites Hotel Asura Thimphu Central Hotel Lhaki Hotel Hotel Ananda
Paro	Gonju Boutique River Front Resort Hotel Khamsum Tshongdu Boutique	ShomoChuki Resort Paro Eco Lodge Dema Resort Hotel Golden Paddy Field	Paro Grand Resort Rema Resort Hotel Olathang Khangkhu Resort

*** The rates given are per person and non-commissionable

*** The rates are valid for Indian nationals only

*** Rooms are subject to availability at the time of booking.

COST BASIS ON INR EX BAGDOGRA AIRPORT (AIRFARE EXTRA)

	3 Star Standard	3 Star Standard	3 Star Deluxe	3 Star Deluxe	3 Star Premium	3 Star Premium
	Breakfast	Breakfast & Dinner	Breakfast	Breakfast & Dinner	Breakfast	Breakfast & Dinner
20 Pax (10 ROOMS)	27,000 PP	29,700 PP	29,200 PP	32,400 PP	33,300 PP	36,900 PP

INCLUSIONS:

- ◆ Accommodation
- ◆ Breakfast at the listed hotels
- ◆ Mineral water bottle daily
- ◆ Certified English-speaking guides throughout the tour (Bhutan Part)
- ◆ Bhutan Sustainable Development Fee (Mandatory) for 03 nights
- ◆ Transportation and sightseeing on private as per the itinerary only (Vehicle, NOT at disposal)
- ◆ Bhutan permit application and procurement in advance

EXCLUSIONS:

- ◆ Entry ticket & Entrance fees to museums and monuments
- ◆ Flight Tickets
- ◆ Lunch and Dinner
- ◆ Travel insurance (recommended)
- ◆ Personal Insurance, evacuation and medical expenses of any kind
- ◆ Expenses of personal nature like bar bills, telephone calls, laundry, extra mileage and any extra costs incurred due to natural calamities, flight delays etc.
- ◆ Gratuity / Tips to guide and driver

TRANSPORT LIST

BHUTAN PART

- 01 Toyota Coaster Bus and 01 Toyota Hiace Bus

INDIA PART

- 01 VAN and 01 Toyota Innova

**** AC won't be entertained while driving up hill*

IMPORTANT NOTE

- ♦ Indian Nationals travelling to Bhutan need a **VALID PASSPORT** or **ORIGINAL VOTER/ELECTION CARD**. The passport must be valid for more than six months from the intended date of departure from the Kingdom. The election card must be original and updated on the ECI portal of India.
- ♦ Children below 18 years without the Passport need an **ORIGINAL BIRTH CERTIFICATE** [in English, computerized format] issued by the office of the Government of India.
- ♦ Aadhar Card, Driving Licence and PAN card are NOT accepted by the Bhutan Immigration as the valid documents to enter Bhutan.

Failure to produce the above documents will lead to denial by the Bhutan Immigration to enter Bhutan.

PHOTOCOPIES OF THE DOCUMENTS & COLOUR PRINT OUTS WITH LAMINATION are NOT accepted by the Bhutan Immigration as the valid documents to enter Bhutan.

